# One place for every issue

A resident-run issue tracker for Marina Residence West

Briefing note | 10 October 2026 | Prepared following the community meeting

## What this is, in one minute

At the meeting the issues raised were slow responses, poor communication and general maintenance. This app is a simple tool, already built and working, that turns each of those complaints into a **dated, photographed record** that the management company has to answer, and that everyone can see the status of.

Residents report from their phone in under a minute. The report goes to management by email, gets a case number, and is tracked until a **resident** confirms with a photo that it is genuinely fixed. Management closing a case is not the same as fixed, and the app keeps the two apart. Every step is time-stamped, so response times and repeat problems are measured, not argued about.

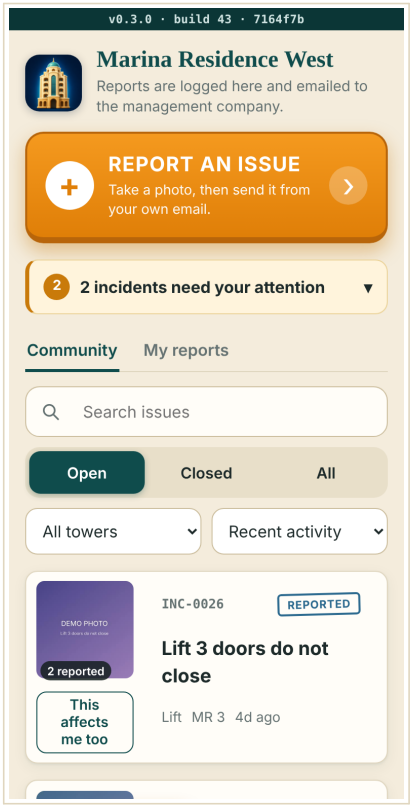
> **The point:** fewer arguments about what was reported and when, and a clear, factual record of how the management company performs, ready to use if escalation is ever needed.

### How it answers the meeting's action points

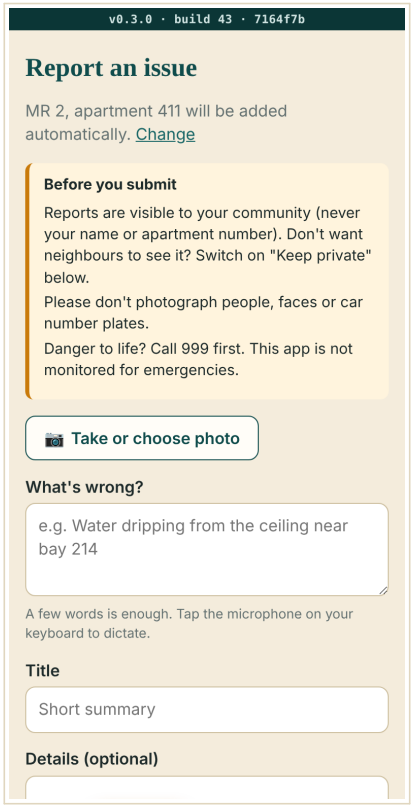
| Action point from the meeting | What the app does today | Still to do |
|---|---|---|
| **Design an issue tracking workflow; set it up (web or shared folder) with escalation rules by date** | Built and running. One shared web app (phone or desktop). Each report has a status, a clock, and flags when it passes its target (no case number in 24h, overdue by priority). Residents get reminders to chase. | Agree the target days with the group (they are adjustable). Escalation letters are not automated. |
| **A simple issue email template for consistency and completeness** | Each report generates a ready-written email to management: what, where, photos (expiring links), reference. The resident sends it from their own email. | Add the "15 day" escalation sentence once we have it from Alex. |
| **Evidence for any future escalation (Dubai Holding, RERA, legal)** | Every report keeps a tamper-evident timeline: report, email sent, replies, case numbers, closures, photos. Export to CSV for an evidence pack. | Escalation paths, legal advice and the English/Arabic letters are a separate document, not part of the app. |
| **Corridor cleaning, general maintenance, preventive maintenance** | Cleaning and maintenance issues are reported with a photo and measured by area and tower. Repeat issues show up in "issues affecting the most homes". | The app measures the response; it does not run a preventive maintenance schedule. |
| **Dilapidations: 60 photos already submitted** | Each item can be logged as a report so it has its own reference, case number and history instead of sitting in a batch. | Decide whether to log the existing 60 photos (CSV import is available). |

# Fast to report, nothing to learn

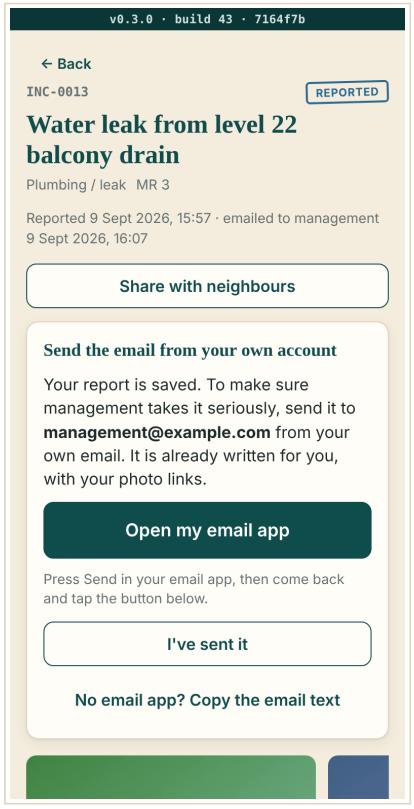
The design rule is that a busy resident should be able to report a problem standing in the corridor, and a neighbour should be able to back it up with one tap.




1. One big button on the home screen




2. Photo, title, Maintenance or Security, send




3. Saved. Your email to management is already written

| For the person reporting | For every other resident |
|---|---|
| **Tap Report an issue, take a photo (location is picked up automatically if allowed).**<br>**Type a short title. Choose Maintenance (the default) or Security, and the urgency.**<br>**Tap send. The email to management is written for them, with the photo links, and opens in their own email app.**<br>**The app then asks for the management case number and reminds them if it is still missing.** | The community list shows what is already reported. If it matches, tap **This affects me too**: no typing, no new report, and the issue's count of affected homes goes up.<br>Similar reports are suggested before a duplicate is made, so management sees one strong case, not ten small ones.<br>Share a report to the WhatsApp group in one tap; the preview shows the title and photo, never a name or flat number.<br>Neighbours never see each other's names or apartment numbers. |

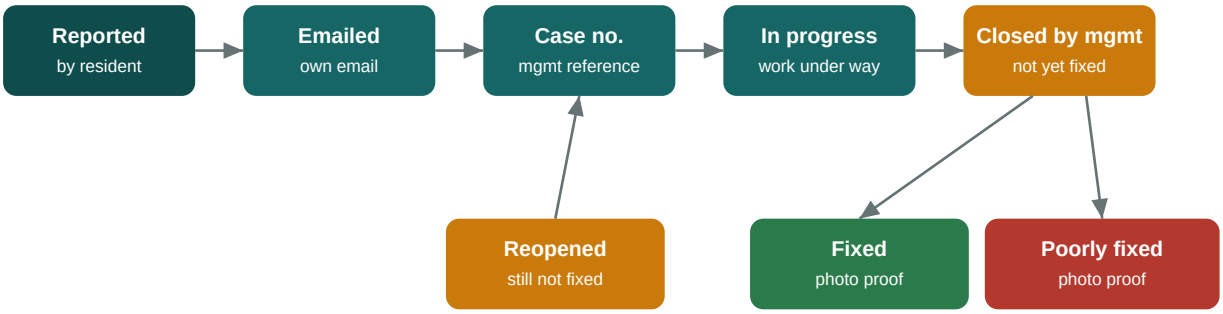
## Joining and signing back in

A new resident asks to join with their email, tower and apartment number and ticks two boxes (what we store, and the terms). A community admin approves or declines, so only real residents are in. After that it is an ordinary sign-in on any phone or computer, and the session stays signed in for the day.

*Timing note:* "under a minute" is the design target (three screens, no accounts to fill in beyond sign-in). It has not yet been timed with real residents; the pilot will measure it.

# The workflow, step by step

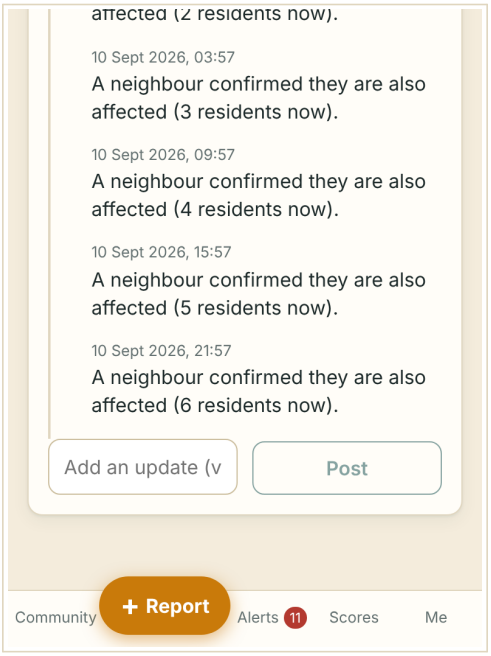
Every report moves through the same stages. At each stage it is clear who has to act and how long it has been waiting.




*Only resident photo evidence (or an admin override with a written note) moves a report to Fixed.*

| Stage | Who acts | What is recorded | Clock / flag |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Reported** | Resident | Photo, title, location, time, tower | Report time stamped |
| **Emailed to management** | Resident sends from own email | Date and time the email went | No case number after 24 hours is flagged |
| **Case number received** | Resident enters management's reference | Case number, time to reply | Reply time measured (target 24h) |
| **In progress** | Resident or admin updates | Management's progress, notes, replies | Overdue flag once past target for its priority |
| **Closed by management** | Management says done | Closure noted as "unverified" | Residents reminded after 3 days to confirm |
| **Fixed / poorly fixed / reopened** | A resident, with a photo | The photo evidence, who and when | Only this counts as fixed. Reopens are counted. |

## The record of one report

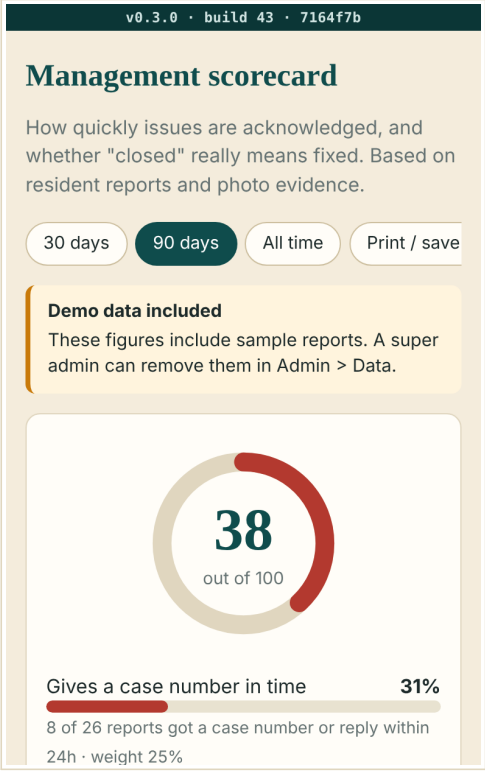



A report's timeline: every step is timed; neighbours confirming "affected" are counted.

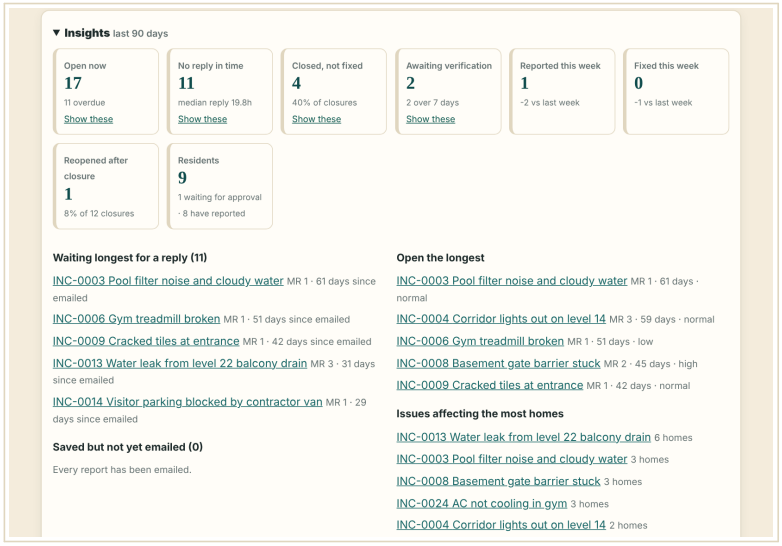
# How performance is measured

The scorecard is built only from the records above. It shows its own definitions so nobody can say the numbers are opinion. It never shows names or apartment numbers to residents.

| Measure | What it counts | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Case number in time** | Share of reports where management gave a case number or reply within the target | 24 hours |
| **Resolves within target time** | Share of reports verified fixed by a resident within the target for their priority | Urgent 2 days, High 7, Normal 14, Low 30 |
| **Fixes hold up** | Of closures, how many a resident confirmed as genuinely fixed, versus poorly fixed or reopened | Higher is better |
| **Closed, but not fixed** | Cases management marked closed that residents dispute or have not verified | Lower is better |
| **Median time to fix** | The middle time from report to verified fix (not skewed by one outlier) | By priority |
| **Overdue open reports** | Open reports older than their target | Zero |
| **Homes affected** | How many residents confirmed the same issue, and which issues affect the most homes | Shows scale |




Scorecard (residents see this); the next page shows all of it

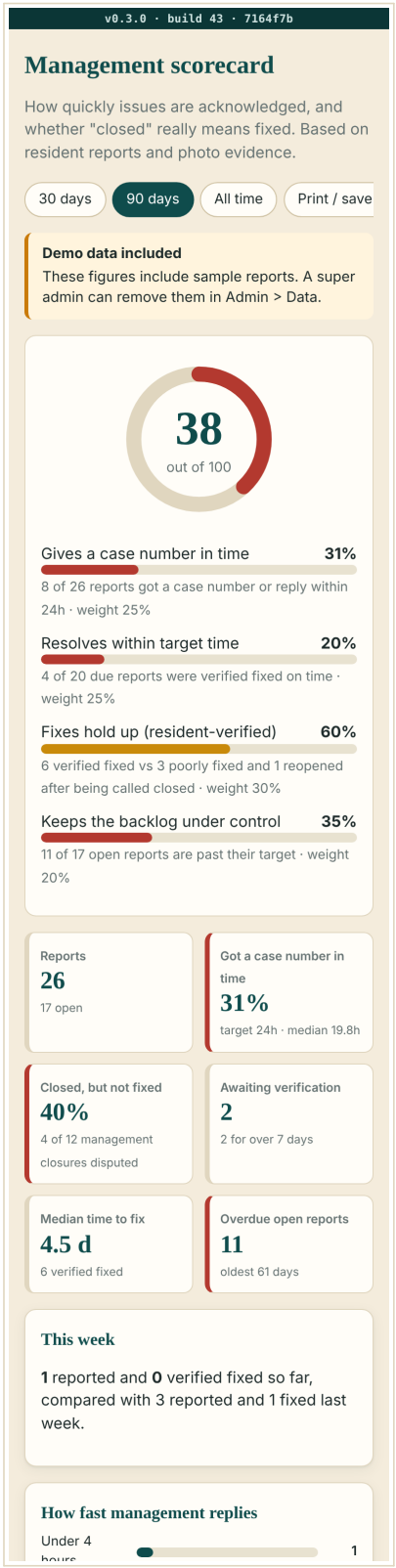



Admin insights: no reply, longest open, homes affected

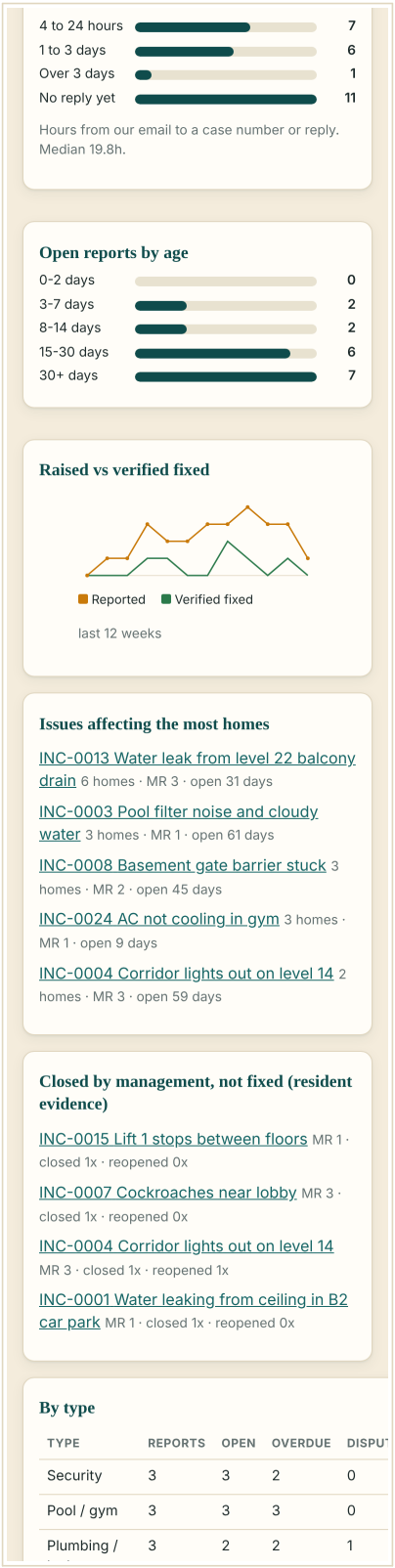
**Wording is kept factual.** The scorecard states what was reported and when, and what management recorded. Its wording still needs a lawyer's review before it is shared outside the community.

# Everything the scorecard shows

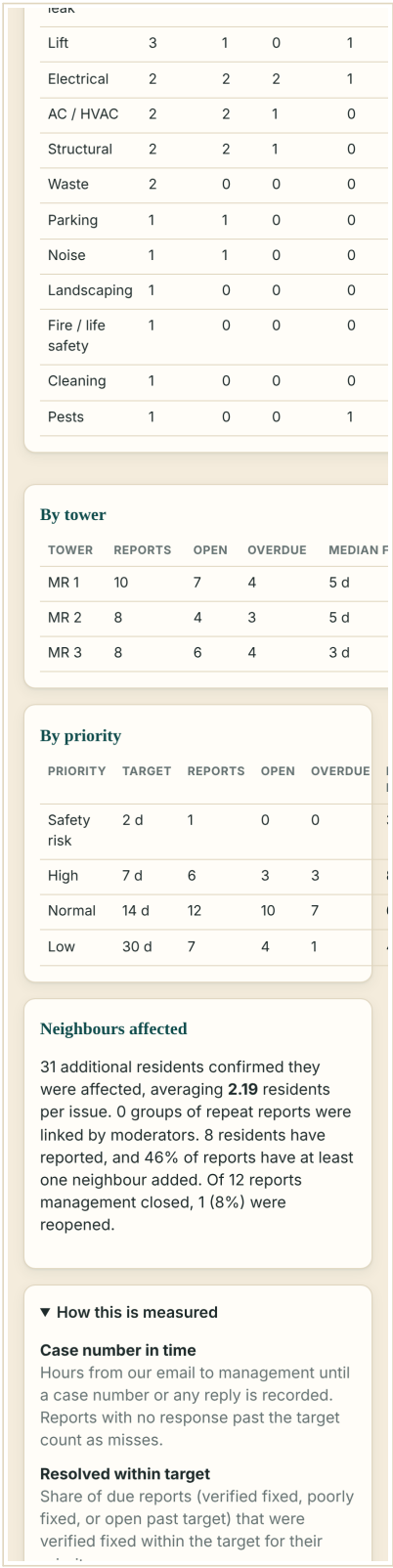
The scorecard is one scrolling page on a phone, with 30-day, 90-day and all-time views and a print or save option. It is shown here in full, in three parts. Sample data is used; the pilot will fill it with real reports.




**1. The headline.** Overall score, four measures with plain-English detail, the key counts and this week versus last




**2. Speed and age.** How fast management replies, how old open reports are, trend, most-affected issues, closed-but-not-fixed, by type




**3. Detail.** Type, tower and priority tables, homes affected, and "How this is measured" (the definitions are in the table on the previous page)

# Anything can be changed

This is a working first version, built to test the idea with residents. Nothing here is fixed. The things the group is most likely to want to adjust:

- **Targets:** the reply time (24 hours) and the fix times by priority are settings, not code.
- **Report types:** currently Maintenance and Security. More can be switched back on if the group wants finer detail.
- **Who can join:** admin approval on or off, an invite link, or admins adding residents directly.
- **Email wording:** the message to management, including any standard escalation sentence the group agrees.
- **What residents see:** the scorecard, the metrics shown, and whether any of it is ever made public.
- **Who runs it:** admin and committee roles; the name of the operating group; the terms of use.

## Security and privacy practices in place

| Area | What is done |
|---|---|
| **Sign-in** | Passwords are stored hashed (scrypt), never in readable form. Accounts lock for 15 minutes after 5 failed attempts. Sessions expire. Admins use a second authenticator-app code. |
| **Who sees what** | Neighbours never see names or apartment numbers. Only admins and the management company do. Residents can mark a report private. |
| **Photos** | Location data is stripped from photos. Photos reach management as expiring links, not email attachments. |
| **Tamper-evident record** | Each timeline entry is chained to the one before it, so history cannot be quietly edited. Admin actions are logged. |
| **Protection against attacks** | Request checks against cross-site abuse, rate limits, standard security headers, and the app runs as a non-privileged user. |
| **Consent and data rights** | Residents agree to the privacy notice and terms at sign-up. They can download or delete their own data. Designed around the UAE Personal Data Protection Law (Federal Decree-Law 45 of 2021). |
| **Where data lives** | Currently on a private test server run by the project owner. A real rollout would keep data in the UAE. |
| **Updates** | The running version is shown at the top of every page, and the admin System page shows update history. |

**Honest status:** this is a pilot on a test server. Still to do before wider use: legal review of the terms, privacy notice and scorecard wording; HTTPS on the public address; connecting the real management email; and an independent security check. None of these changes how residents use it.